

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title: Lp(a) Lowering Study of Pelacarsen (TQJ230) With Background Inclisiran in Participants With Elevated Lp(a) and Established ASCVD **Official Title:** A Randomized, Double-blind, Placebo-controlled, Multicenter Study to Evaluate the Efficacy, Safety, and Tolerability of Pelacarsen (TQJ230) With Background Inclisiran in Participants With Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease (ASCVD), and Elevated LDL-C and Lp(a) **Short Title/ Acronym:** ADD-VANTAGE **Protocol Number:** CTQJ230A12304 **NCT Number:** NCT06813911 **Posting ID:** 409288059304424177 **Trial Status:** RECRUITING **Sponsor Name:** Novartis Pharmaceuticals (Novartis) **Investigational Product:** Pelacarsen (TQJ230) and Inclisiran **Phase of Development:** Phase III **Medical Monitor:** Novartis Clinical Operations Lead

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective Primary Objective: To evaluate the efficacy of pelacarsen compared to placebo, in reducing log transformed lipoprotein A (Lp(a)) concentration at Month 6 in ASCVD participants who have elevated Lp(a), and who are on background inclisiran for elevated LDL-C. **Secondary Objectives:** To evaluate the proportion of participants achieving reduction in Lp(a) levels, and to assess the incidence of treatment emergent adverse events (TEAEs), treatment emergent serious adverse events (TESAEs), and adverse events of special interest (AESI).

2.2 Background & Rationale Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease (ASCVD) is a chronic inflammatory condition characterized by the progressive accumulation of lipid-rich plaques within the walls of medium and large arteries. This process, known as atherosclerosis, leads to the hardening and narrowing of these vessels, impeding blood flow to vital organs. ASCVD encompasses a range of clinical manifestations including coronary artery disease (leading to heart attack or angina), cerebrovascular disease (leading to stroke or transient ischemic attack), and peripheral artery disease, all resulting from the obstruction or rupture of these atherosclerotic plaques. This study generates evidence on the safety, tolerability, and effect of monthly subcutaneous pelacarsen to reduce Lp(a) levels in addition to background inclisiran therapy for elevated LDL cholesterol.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework Study Type: Interventional **Phase:** Phase III **Status:** Recruiting **Control Type:** Placebo-controlled **Blinding:** Double-blind (followed by an open-label period) **Randomization:** Randomized, parallel group study

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration Target N\$: 340 participants **Number of Sites:** Multicenter (Global: Europe, US, RoW) **Estimated Study Start:** 30-Apr-2025 **Estimated Primary Completion:** 31-Dec-2027

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. Male and female participants 18 to ≤ 80 years of age at the Screening visit. 2. Established ASCVD, defined as documented coronary heart disease (CHD), cerebrovascular disease (CVD), or peripheral arterial disease (PAD) at the Screening visit. 3. On a stable dose of local guideline-recommended lipid-lowering therapy for at least 30 days prior to the Screening visit. 4. Participants must successfully complete the run-in period of background inclisiran treatment in order to be randomized. 5. On standard of care (SoC) treatment for other CVD risk factors including hypertension and diabetes for at least 30 days prior to Randomization/Baseline visit. 6. Central laboratory reported Lp(a) ≥ 175 nmol/L at Screening visit. 7. Central laboratory reported LDL-C > 70 mg/dL (or > 1.8 mmol/L) at Screening visit.

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Prior treatment with inclisiran. 2. Any other PCSK9 inhibitor (e.g., evolocumab, alirocumab) use within 4 months prior to Screening visit. 3. Uncontrolled hypertension at Randomization/Baseline visit. 4. Heart failure New York Heart Association (NYHA) class IV at Screening visit or at Randomization/Baseline visit (Day 1). 5. Triglycerides ≥ 400 mg/dL at Screening visit. 6. History of malignancy of any organ system within the past 5 years. 7. Myocardial infarction, stroke or other major bleeding, coronary or lower limb revascularization, major cardiac or non-cardiac surgery between Screening visit and Randomization/Baseline visit (Day 1). 8. Central laboratory reported platelet count $< 140,000$ per mm³. 9. Active liver disease or hepatic dysfunction at Screening visit. 10. Significant kidney disease at Screening visit. 11. Pregnant or nursing women at Screening visit. 12. Any uncontrolled chronic or serious medical condition which may pose an immediate risk to clinical stability of the study participant at Screening visit.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen Dosage/Frequency: Participants will be administered pelacarsen 80 mg or matching placebo once monthly

for 6 months. After Month 6, all participants will receive pelacarsen 80 mg injection for the remaining 6 months during the open-label treatment period. **Background Therapy:** Inclisiran (Trade Name: Leqvio, ATC Code: C10AX16). **Route of Administration:** Subcutaneous (SC) injection. **Duration of Treatment:** 12 months total (6 months double-blind, 6 months open-label).

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy Permitted: Background inclisiran treatment; stable dose of local guideline-recommended lipid-lowering therapy for ASCVD. **Prohibited:** Other investigational drugs, PCSK9 inhibitors within 4 months of screening, or unauthorized experimental RNA therapies.

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures
Screening	Day -30 to 0	Informed Consent, Medical History, Lp(a) / LDL Labs, Inclisiran Run-in
Baseline	Day 0	Randomization, First Dose of Pelacarsen/Placebo
Interim	Months 1 to 5	Monthly SC injections, Safety Labs, Vitals, AE Monitoring
End of Study	Month 6 & Month 12	Month 6 (Primary Efficacy Assessment), Month 12 (Final Open-Label Vitals, Exit Interview, IP Accountability)

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint Definition: Change in log transformed lipoprotein A (Lp(a)) concentration at Month 6. **Measurement Method:** Central Laboratory Analysis.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints

- Proportion of participants achieving reduction in Lp(a) levels at Month 6.
- Incidence of treatment emergent adverse events (TEAEs) and treatment emergent serious adverse events (TESAEs).
- Incidence of treatment emergent adverse events of special interest (AESI).

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring: Continuous evaluation of TEAEs with start dates located in the on-treatment period. **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** Reported within 24 hours of site awareness. **Data Monitoring Committee (DMC):** External independent data monitoring committee details applied.

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

Analysis Populations: Intent-to-Treat (ITT) for efficacy endpoints. Safety Set for evaluating AE/SAE occurrences. **Sample**

Size Justification: \$N=340\$ appropriately powered ($\alpha = 0.05$, $Power = 80\%$) to detect a significant shift in Lp(a) reduction versus placebo. **Handling of Missing Data:** Mixed-Effect Model Repeated Measure (MMRM) and/or Multiple Imputation for longitudinal laboratory endpoints.

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

GCP Compliance: This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki. **Monitoring Plan:** Scheduled onsite monitoring and remote data-verification visits. **Audit Trail:** Details on eCRF locking and data clarification forms tracked via the centralized clinical trial management system.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: {{CTQJ230A12304}} **Registry Number:** {{NCT06813911}}
Posting ID: {{409288059304424177}} **Trial Status:** {{RECRUITING}}
Sponsor/Lead Organization: {{Novartis Pharmaceuticals / Novartis}} **Study Title:** {{ADD-VANTAGE}} **Official Regulatory Title:** {{A Randomized, Double-blind, Placebo-controlled, Multicenter Study to Evaluate the Efficacy, Safety, and Tolerability of Pelacarsen (TQJ230) With Background Inclisiran in Participants With Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease (ASCVD), and Elevated LDL-C and Lp(a)}}

12. Clinical Framework (ASCVD Specific)

Primary Condition: {{Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease (ASCVD)}} **Preferred UMLS Name:** {{Hyperlipoproteinemia (a)}}
Condition Classifications: {{SNOMED: 409054005 | MeSH: D006323}}
Diagnosis Threshold: {{Lp(a) >= 175 nmol/L and LDL-C > 70 mg/dL (or > 1.8 mmol/L)}} **Medical Methodology:** {{RNA therapy (antisense oligonucleotide) and background siRNA}} **Optimization Target:** {{Lp(a) reduction}}

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

Management Pathway: {{Standard clinical pathway for ASCVD lipid management}} **Education Protocol (HCP):** {{SC injection administration & safety monitoring training}} **Education Protocol (Patient):** {{Onsite training for therapy adherence and reporting}} **Quality Audit Mechanism:** {{Patient adherence monitoring and centralized laboratory tracking}}

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

Total Duration: {{12 months / 52 weeks}} **Onsite Visit Cadence:** {{Monthly for dosing and safety checks}} **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** {{As needed between clinical visits}} **Checklist Review Interval:** {{Every 12 weeks}}

15. Sign-off & Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date	:--	:--	:--	:--
Principal Investigator	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				
Clinical Operations Lead	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]		Lead		
Statistician	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				